Mark Scheme — Vocabulary Test 1

Section A — Vocabulary in Context

(a) 'helpless stupor' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('helpless') powerless / unable to do anything / without control / defenceless / weak
- ('stupor') daze / dazed state / semi-conscious state / mental numbness / unable to think clearly

Guidance: For 'stupor' do NOT credit 'tired' / 'sleepy' / 'unconscious'. LOOK FOR a sense of being mentally frozen.

(b) 'theatrically flung' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('theatrically') in a dramatic / exaggerated / showy manner / as if performing / over the top / for attention
- ('flung') threw open / opened suddenly / opened forcefully / pushed open with energy / yanked open

Guidance: For 'theatrically' do NOT credit 'happily' / 'angrily'. LOOK FOR deliberate exaggeration or performance.

Section B — Word Choice

(c) 'lunged rather than rushed' **[1 mark]**

Award 1 mark for any of the following:

- the movement was sudden / abrupt / a targeted attack / aggressive / like a thrust
- rushed just means moving quickly; lunged implies a sudden forward leap aimed at someone

Guidance: LOOK FOR any suggestion of sudden, targeted aggression.

(d) 'cackled rather than laughed' **[1 mark]**

Award 1 mark for any of the following:

- the laugh was harsh / broken / unpleasant / shrill / rough-sounding
- the woman sounds frightening / wicked / cruel / evil // makes her seem like a witch

Guidance: LOOK FOR harsh, cruel quality. Do NOT credit 'loud' alone.

Section C — Writer's Effect

(e) 'billowing' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- the flames are large / expanding / swelling outward / rising in waves / surging
- powerful / uncontrollable / overwhelming // rolling forward like waves or clouds
- creates danger / the reader feels anxious / petrified

Guidance: Focus on size, movement, power. NOT: bright / hot / red.

MISS JAY
O & A LEVEL ENGLISH

Jaweria Amer

(f) 'taut' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- his face is tight / stretched / strained / pulled / not relaxed
- he is tense / anxious / nervous / under pressure / extremely focused / determined
- the task is difficult / demanding // the reader feels the tension

Guidance: LOOK FOR tension or intense concentration. NOT: angry / upset.

Section D — Word Bank Answers

(g) swab — To clean a wound or area with absorbent material / dab
(h) translucent — Allowing light through but not fully transparent / semi-opaque
(i) rigging — A system of ropes and cables supporting a structure / tackle
(j) squints — Looks with eyes partly closed to see more clearly / peers
(k) mockery — Cruel ridicule / the act of making fun of someone
(l) swaddle — To wrap tightly in cloth for comfort or warmth / bind

Distractors (unused): trudge, glint

Mark Breakdown:

Section A — Vocabulary in Context (a–b)	4
Section B — Word Choice (c–d)	2
Section C — Writer's Effect (e–f)	4
Section D — Word Bank (g–l)	6
TOTAL	**16**

END OF MARKING SCHEME — TEST 1

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